

Budget Justification

Personnel Costs

George Mason University defines an academic year as the period from the start of one academic year to the start of the next.

Key Personnel

Principal Investigator. Dr. Oughton, Principal Investigator (PI), will provide overall leadership and management of the project. Responsibilities include organizing and overseeing workshop activities; coordinating with the organizing and advisory committees; supervising project personnel; preparing workshop materials; overseeing dissemination activities; and preparing required reports. The PI will devote the effort specified in the budget to these activities. Dr. Oughton is budgeted at 0.18 monthly effort.

Co-Principal Investigator. Dr. Sprintson, a Co-PI, will assist with workshop planning, participant recruitment, technical program development, breakout session coordination, preparation of workshop deliverables, and dissemination of workshop outcomes. Effort levels are specified in the budget. Dr. Sprintson is budgeted at 0.08 monthly effort.

In addition to the Principal Investigator, we have budgeted a GMU College of Science Administrator who would assist with clerical duties and reimbursement of the participants.

Fringe Benefits

George Mason University's negotiated fringe benefit rates for Fiscal Year 2027 are applied as follows:

- Faculty: 33.1%
- Staff: 42.9%

The rates quoted above are subject to adjustment if superseding government-approved rates are established. Salaries, wages, and fringe benefits are estimates and will be paid and billed in accordance with university policy.

Other Direct Costs

Workshop and Conference Expenses

Funds are requested to support workshop operations and participant engagement activities. These expenses include:

- Venue rental and meeting facilities;
- Audio-visual and technical support services;
- Workshop materials and supplies;
- Working-group lunches and refreshment breaks;
- Printing, signage, and participant materials;

- Administrative support and workshop logistics.

The total amount requested for workshop expenses is \$16,000.

Participant Support Costs

Participant support funds are requested to facilitate attendance by researchers, students, and practitioners who might otherwise be unable to participate. These funds will support travel, lodging, and per diem expenses associated with workshop participation. Participant support costs are calculated as follows:

Category	Calculation	Amount
Travel	16 participants $\times$ \$450	\$7,200
Lodging	16 participants $\times$ 2 nights $\times$ \$200	\$6,400
Stipend	16 participants $\times$ \$50/day $\times$ 3 days	\$2,400
Total Participant Support		\$16,000

These funds will help ensure broad participation from academia, industry, government, and early-career researchers.

Data Management and Sharing Justification

No data management and sharing costs will be incurred for this project.

Facilities and Administrative Costs (F&A)

George Mason University has a negotiated Other Sponsored Activities Facilities and Administrative (F&A) rate of 41.8% of Modified Total Direct Costs (MTDC), as approved by the Office of Naval Research. George Mason University will comply with all applicable federal regulations and guidance governing indirect costs. The total indirect cost amount is included in the proposal budget.